

Build where you differentiate, buy where you maintain

Build	Hybrid	Buy
the firm's control statement, evidence or domain logic	bought or open engine, firm-owned interface and policy	commodity, with a heavy security and maintenance burden
L4 Tool servers read-only, owned by system teams	L3 Orchestration adopt open frameworks; build workflows	L1 Foundation models hosted models; adopt open weights
L5 Memory service thin, later: write gate, recall, forget	L7 Retrieval optimisation thin embed and rerank service; own evaluation set	L2 Serving buy access; open engine as the exit
C5 Configuration of record release manifest, evaluation gate, approval rules	L8 Ingestion build the envelope; adopt the parsers	L6 Retrieval stores reuse the database you run
C6 AI FinOps thin: cost dataset, cost per task, allocation rules	L9 Evaluation and observability datasets and scorers in source control	C7 AI security tooling bought, inside the firm's architecture
C8 Evidence store inventory and immutable evidence; workflow tool optional	C1 AI traffic gateway routes, fallback lists and budgets as data	
	C2 Guardrails policy, numeric check and test sets; detectors bought	
THE SIGNAL Configuration coverage production calls resolving to an approved version the firm holds. Target for regulated outputs: 100%	C3 Privacy service one API, own recognisers; adopt engine	DO NOT BUILD YET Fine-tuning adds a model to validate, and can, in some cases, turn a deployer into a provider under the EU AI Act
	C4 Identity and authorisation buy the identity provider, build the policy	